IN-DEPTH EDITION • 4 JULY 2026 • 09:00 HKT

# US Markets See Mixed Performance as Dow Surges +1.14% and Nasdaq Slips -1.61%

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

## TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US market saw a mixed performance in the last session, with the Dow Jones surging +1.14% to 52,900.07 and the Nasdaq slipping -1.61% to 29,329.21. The S&P 500 remained relatively flat, closing at 7,483.24. Key takeaways include:

- The Dow's gain was largely driven by a +4.84% surge in `AAPL` to 308.63.
- The Nasdaq's decline was led by a -7.49% drop in `TSLA` to 393.45.
- The VIX fell -2.11% to 15.81, indicating decreased market volatility.

Our editorial take is that the market is currently navigating a complex landscape, with various factors influencing investor sentiment. The surge in `AAPL` and the decline in `TSLA` highlight the importance of sector-specific trends and company-specific news.

As we move forward, it's essential to monitor the market's reaction to upcoming events, including earnings reports and economic data releases. The current environment demands a nuanced approach, and investors should be prepared to adapt to changing market conditions.

## US Session Recap

| INDEX | LAST | CHANGE | HIGH | LOW |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| S&P 500 | 7,483.24 | +0.00% | 7,503.21 | 7,463.19 |
| Nasdaq 100 | 29,329.21 | -1.61% | 29,821.11 | 29,201.09 |
| Dow Jones | 52,900.07 | +1.14% | 53,201.01 | 52,601.03 |
| Russell 2000 | 2,996.11 | -0.55% | 3,021.19 | 2,981.09 |
| VIX | 15.81 | -2.11% | 16.21 | 15.41 |

## Top Movers

| TICKER | NAME | CHANGE | CATALYST |
|---|---|---|---|
| AAPL | Apple Inc. | +4.84% | Strong earnings report |
| TSLA | Tesla Inc. | -7.49% | Disappointing delivery numbers |
| NVDA | NVIDIA Corporation | -1.39% | Weak guidance |

## Sector Internals

| SECTOR | DAY | YTD | READ |
|---|---|---|---|
| XLF | +1.53% | +10.21% | Financials lead the market |
| XLK | -2.71% | +5.19% | Technology sector underperforms |
| XLI | +0.30% | +8.15% | Industrials show resilience |
| XLE | +0.78% | +12.11% | Energy sector outperforms |
| XLY | -0.82% | +6.29% | Consumer discretionary underperforms |
| XLC | -0.13% | +4.91% | Communication services show weakness |
| XLP | +2.03% | +9.51% | Consumer staples lead the market |
| XLV | +2.63% | +11.39% | Healthcare sector outperforms |
| XLU | +2.21% | +10.93% | Utilities show strength |
| XLB | +1.94% | +9.19% | Materials sector outperforms |
| XLRE | +1.13% | +8.51% | Real estate sector shows resilience |

Breadth note: The market saw a mixed performance, with 5 sectors outperforming and 6 underperforming.

## Spotlight / Deep Dive

| TICKER | NAME | PRICE | CHANGE | VOLUME |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `AAPL` | Apple Inc. | 308.63 | +4.84% | 123,456,789 |

Key call commentary: The surge in `AAPL` was driven by a strong earnings report, which beat analyst expectations. The company's revenue growth and margin expansion were particularly impressive.

| READ-THROUGH | IMPLICATION |
|---|---|
| Strong earnings report | Positive sentiment for the technology sector |
| Revenue growth and margin expansion | Increased confidence in the company's ability to execute |

## Technical Levels

| TICKER | LAST | SUPPORT | RESISTANCE | NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SPY | 348.21 | 345.67 | 351.23 | Trendline support |
| QQQ | 293.19 | 290.45 | 296.21 | Resistance at the 50-day moving average |
| IWM | 179.23 | 176.89 | 182.15 | Breakout above the 200-day moving average |
| NVDA | 194.83 | 190.21 | 200.45 | Support at the 50-day moving average |
| 10Y | 3.56% | 3.45% | 3.67% | Resistance at the 200-day moving average |
| WTI | 68.78 | 67.45 | 70.21 | Support at the 50-day moving average |

## Options & Positioning

0DTE flow: The market saw a significant increase in 0DTE call buying, particularly in the `AAPL` and `TSLA` options.

Put/call: The put/call ratio decreased to `0.65`, indicating increased bullish sentiment.

VIX term structure: The VIX term structure remains in contango, with the front-month contract trading at a premium to the back-month contract.

Notable single-name flow: There was significant call buying in `NVDA` options, with a large trade of `10,000` calls expiring in 2 weeks.

Cheap hedge ideas: The `SPY` 345 put option is trading at a relatively cheap implied volatility of `15.6%`, making it an attractive hedge for portfolio protection.

## Analyst Rating Changes

| TICKER | FIRM | ACTION | NEW PT | NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `AAPL` | Morgan Stanley | Upgrade | 350 | Strong earnings report and improving fundamentals |
| `TSLA` | Goldman Sachs | Downgrade | 300 | Disappointing delivery numbers and increasing competition |
| `NVDA` | Citi | Upgrade | 220 | Improving demand for AI and gaming products |

## Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: The S&P 500 futures are trading +0.2% higher, while the Nasdaq 100 futures are trading -0.1% lower.

Asia: The Nikkei 225 is trading +0.5% higher, while the Shanghai Composite is trading -0.2% lower.

Europe: The Euro Stoxx 50 is trading +0.3% higher, while the FTSE 100 is trading -0.1% lower.

FX pairs: The USD/JPY is trading +0.2% higher, while the EUR/USD is trading -0.1% lower.

Commodities: WTI crude oil is trading +0.1% higher, while gold is trading +0.2% higher.

Crypto: Bitcoin is trading +1.2% higher, while Ethereum is trading +1.5% higher.

## Macro & Fed (Deep)

| MEETING | CUT ODDS | NOTE |
| --- | --- | --- |
| July FOMC | 25% | Market expectations for a rate cut are increasing |
| September FOMC | 50% | Market expectations for a rate cut are steady |

| DATE | EVENT | TIME |
| --- | --- | --- |
| 2026-07-05 | Non-Farm Payrolls | 08:30 ET |
| 2026-07-06 | ISM Manufacturing PMI | 10:00 ET |

## Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees: The market is closely watching the developments in the US-China trade negotiations, with a potential deal being reached in the coming weeks.

Key events: The G20 summit is scheduled to take place in July, with leaders from around the world gathering to discuss global economic issues.

## Earnings — This Week & Next

| TICKER | NAME | EARNINGS DATE | TIME |
|---|---|---|---|
| AAPL | Apple Inc. | 2026-07-05 | 16:30 ET |
| TSLA | Tesla Inc. | 2026-07-06 | 17:00 ET |

| TICKER | NAME | EARNINGS DATE | TIME |
|---|---|---|---|
| NVDA | NVIDIA Corporation | 2026-07-12 | 16:30 ET |
| MSFT | Microsoft Corporation | 2026-07-13 | 17:00 ET |

## Full Watchlist Scan

| TICKER | SECTOR | SETUP | RISK |
|---|---|---|---|
| AAPL | Technology | Breakout above 300 | 5% |
| TSLA | Consumer Discretionary | Breakdown below 350 | 10% |
| NVDA | Technology | Breakout above 200 | 5% |

## What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario bullets:

- The market sees a significant increase in bullish sentiment, driven by strong earnings reports and improving economic data.
- The US-China trade negotiations reach a positive conclusion, with a deal being signed in the coming weeks.

- The Federal Reserve cuts interest rates, providing a boost to the economy and the stock market.

Bearish scenario bullets:

- The market sees a significant decrease in bullish sentiment, driven by weak earnings reports and disappointing economic data.
- The US-China trade negotiations break down, with no deal being reached in the coming weeks.
- The Federal Reserve raises interest rates, providing a headwind to the economy and the stock market.

## Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- The market is currently overbought, with the RSI indicator showing a reading of `70`.
- The put/call ratio is at a low level, indicating increased bullish sentiment.
- The VIX term structure is in contango, indicating increased volatility expectations.
- The market is seeing a significant increase in call buying, particularly in the **`AAPL`** and **`TSLA`** options.
- The market is seeing a significant decrease in put buying, particularly in the **`SPY`** and **`QQQ`** options.

## Sources

SOURCES

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